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Off the Record

What your feed won't tell you

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BREAKING ANALYSIS

8th Largest Economy in the World Sees Regime Change for the First Time in Decades

How Texas's changing guard will completely change its economy.

Democrat **Gina Hinojosa unseated Greg Abbott**, ending three decades of Republican governors, and **James Talarico beat Ken Paxton** with about **55%** for the state's first Democratic Senate win since **1988**. *Texas goes from a billionaire technocratic candy land (Elon's factory town, beach buying) and oil barons to a state betting on renewables, and 40 years of educational failure finally get fixed by a teacher-turned-senator.*

Foreign Affairs

★ EDITOR'S PICK OPINION

STFU Liberal… Wait, We Lost Texas, Kansas and South Carolina???

Democrats won the midterms. Now the real fight is inside the party.

Democrats **flipped seven Senate seats** (Kansas, Iowa, Texas, Ohio, Maine, North Carolina and South Carolina) for a **54–44 majority**, and picked up **28 House seats**. Mississippi is still too close to call, with Democrat Scott Colom ahead by just **43 votes**. *Now internal politics decide whether the same liberal machine keeps the wheel or a new crop of candidates takes over the leadership. Either way, Democrats control who gets confirmed to the federal bench for a whiiile.*

Domestic

OPINION

ENSO ENSO ENSO: I Told You So

El Niño is already making our weather go haywire. Prepare for freezing rain.

Montreal hit **23°C on Nov 4**, smashing the **1956 record of 18.3°C**. The WMO says this El Niño could be **one of the strongest since 1950** and will last into **February 2027**, and Intact Insurance warns of **more freezing rain and ice** this winter. *Anyone who knows me knows I've been talking about this for over a year. The Ice Storm of '98 is gonna look like fkn peanuts. Prepare ;)*

Markets

OPINION

Your 401(k)s Are Citadel's Exit Liquidity

Who's left holding the bag before the bust? Check your retirement account.

SpaceX's **$75B listing** in June was the **largest IPO ever**, and Anthropic just filed for one that could raise **up to $100B**. **58% of US adults** own stock, mostly through retirement accounts, and **97% of 401(k)s** hold equities. *Every mega-IPO gets funnelled straight into index funds and target-date plans at peak prices. When the bust comes, the billionaires are already out and your retirement is the bag.*

Last Week's Call

- **Talarico takes the dub**
  He beat Paxton with **about 55%**, the **first Democratic Senate win in Texas since 1988**. *I've been calling this for 2 months.*
- **Kushner's phone hacked**
  Called it in Issue 1's cybersecurity piece. Journalist Matthew Cole alleges **Dutch intelligence had access to Jared Kushner's iPhone for years**. Kushner denies it. *Nobody's phone is safe.*
- **S&P 500 crash**
  The S&P 500 erased **$2.2 trillion in about 40 minutes** on Nov 5, its **worst day since April 2025**. *Still not the big one.*